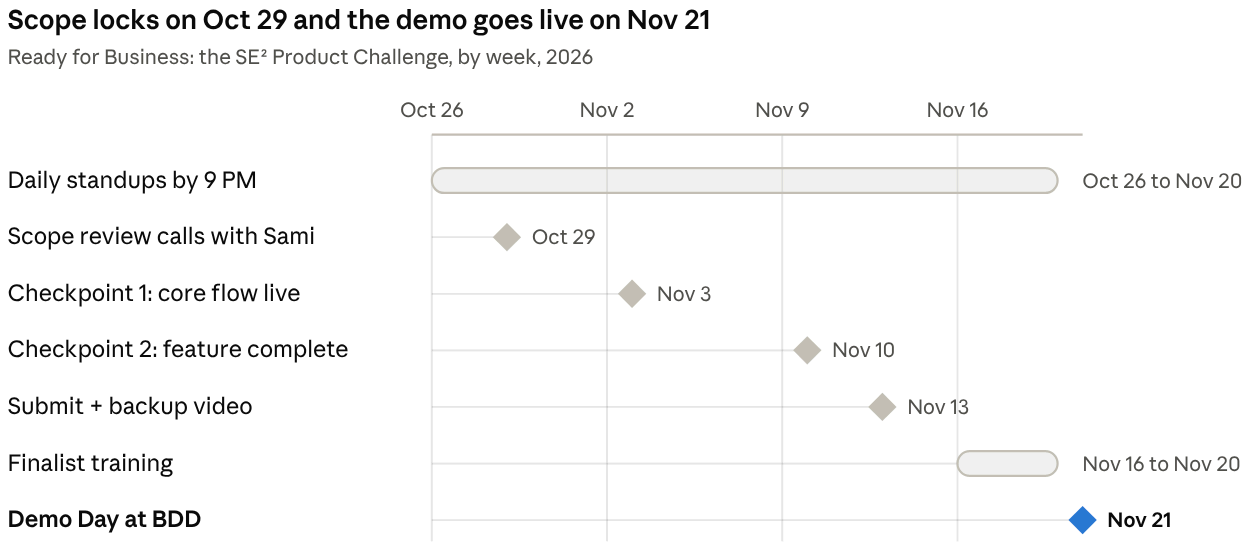
Ready for Business: Demo-Ready Standard and Scope Lock

Oct 26, 2026 · @Sami Shames El Deen

The next four weeks

Demo Day is Saturday 21 November, live on stage at Beirut Digital District in front of about 300 people. Five teams will present.

This doc covers three things you need this week: what a demo-ready project looks like, how to lock your scope by Thursday 29 October, and how to post your daily standup.



challenge timeline · scope lock to Demo Day

Each checkpoint is a gate. If your team misses one, we book a rescoping session with you that same week

What "demo-ready" means

A demo-ready project lets a stranger in the audience see a real small business problem solved, live, in three minutes. We judge outcome, not output: a working product with business impact beats a big feature list or a long GitHub history.

Every project must meet all seven of these:

1. **One core flow works end to end, live.** A real user goes from start to result with no skipped steps, no fake screens and no "imagine this part works."
2. **It runs on a public URL.** Not localhost. If it needs a login, prepare a demo account that is already signed in.
3. **It uses realistic data.** Seed it with data that looks like a real business: real-looking customer names, prices, invoices or orders. No "test123" or lorem ipsum. If you generate fake data, make it Lebanese: Lebanese names, local areas like Hamra or Jounieh, prices in USD or LBP, and +961 phone numbers, so the audience recognizes it instantly.
4. **The AI is engineered, not wrapped.** You can show where the model sits in your system, what it decides, how you check its output, and what happens when it is wrong.
5. **The business outcome is clear.** You can name the exact user, what they do today, and what your product saves or earns them, as a number. Evidence from a real business conversation makes this much stronger.
6. **You can tell it in three minutes.** Use the story structure below.
7. **You have a backup.** A recorded backup video of the full demo.

The three-minute story

This is a suggested structure, not the only option. Shape your story your own way, as long as you show the problem, the live product and the outcome within your time.

Time	What you show
0:00 to 0:30	The problem: who the user is and what it costs them today
0:30 to 2:15	The live demo of your one core flow
2:15 to 2:45	One architecture slide: how the system and the AI fit together
2:45 to 3:00	The outcome in one number, and what comes next

Demo-ready vs not yet

Demo-ready	Not yet
One flow that works every time	Five features that each half work

Demo-ready	Not yet
Live product on a public URL	Slides or a video instead of the product
Demo account already signed in	Typing passwords and waiting for email codes on stage
Handles a wrong or empty input calmly	Crashes when someone types something unexpected
"Cuts invoice entry from 20 minutes to 2"	"Uses GPT to make invoicing smarter"
AI output is checked, with a fallback	Whatever the model returns goes straight to the user

How the five finalists are chosen

After submissions close on Friday 13 November, Sami and the two associate instructors pick the five finalists. The deciding question is simple: which demos are strongest and most impressive when they run live on stage.

We look at four things:

- **It works.** The core flow runs live, end to end, without rescue.
- **It matters to a business.** A real small or medium business would want this, and the outcome is shown as a number.
- **It is well engineered.** Sound architecture, AI used with checks and fallbacks, not a thin prompt wrapper.
- **It is told well.** A clear three-minute story that a non-technical person in the audience can follow.

Finalists get a full week of training from 16 to 20 November to sharpen the pitch and rehearse before Demo Day.

Lock your scope by Thursday 29 October

Every team locks its scope in a 15 to 20 minute call with Sami by the end of Thursday 29 October. Most projects that fail on demo day fail because they tried to build too much, so this call is where we cut.

1. **Fill the scope template below as a team.** It takes about 30 to 45 minutes. Be specific; vague answers get sent back.
2. **Book your 1:1 scope review call with Sami:** book your slot here. All calls run on Thursday 29 October. One team member books the meeting and adds the rest of the team as guests, so everyone gets the invite. One booking per team.
3. **Send your filled template at least 3 hours before your call** to your team's channel on Discord. Name it "Scope: [Team name]".
4. **On the call,** we confirm your core flow, agree what must work on stage, and move anything extra to your cut list.
5. **After the call your scope is locked.** You can always cut more. Adding a new feature needs Sami's approval first.

Teams that have not booked by end of Tuesday 27 October will be contacted directly.

Scope template

Copy everything in the box, fill every field, and send it before your call.

```
# Scope: [Team name]

## 1. Team
- Members and what each one owns (frontend, backend, AI, pitch):

## 2. Product in one sentence
We help [specific type of small or medium business] [do what] so they [get
what outcome].

## 3. The user
- Who exactly uses it (role, type of business):
- Real businesses you have talked to (name, how many conversations):

## 4. The problem today
- How they do it now:
- What it costs them (hours per week, money, errors):

## 5. The one core flow
The steps a user takes live on stage, start to result (5 to 7 steps max):
1.
2.
3.
```

```
## 6. Where the AI fits
- What the model does in this flow:
- What goes in, what comes out:
- How you check the output before the user sees it:
- What happens when the model is wrong or slow:

## 7. Tech stack and hosting
- Stack:
- Where it will be deployed:

## 8. Must work on stage (max 5)
1.
2.
3.

## 9. Cut list (not building before Demo Day)
-

## 10. The outcome number
The one number you will show on stage (example: "invoice entry drops from 20
minutes to 2"):

## 11. Biggest risk
- What could stop the demo from working:
- Your plan if it happens:

## 12. Checkpoint plan
For each checkpoint, write what will be done and who owns it. Be concrete:
name the screens, features and deploy steps, not "work on the backend".

### Checkpoint 1, Tue 3 Nov: core flow working and deployed
Goal: the core flow from section 5 runs end to end on your public URL. It can
still be ugly.
- What will work by then:
- Who owns each part:
- What is still mocked or hardcoded:

### Checkpoint 2, Tue 10 Nov: feature complete
Goal: every item in section 8 works, the AI checks and fallbacks from section
6 are in, and realistic data is seeded.
- What you will add after Checkpoint 1:
- Who owns each part:
```

```
- When your 3-minute demo script draft will be ready:

### Submission, Fri 13 Nov: polished and recorded
Goal: no new features. Fix bugs, polish the UI, record the backup video.
- What you will fix and polish:
- Who records the backup video, and on which day:

Example (Checkpoint 1):
- Works: a shop owner uploads a photo of a supplier invoice, the AI extracts
items and prices, and the result shows on the dashboard
- Owners: Rami (upload and storage), Lina (AI extraction and checks), Karim
(dashboard and deployment)
- Still mocked: login and PDF export
```

Daily standup

Starting today, every team posts one standup a day by 9:00 PM Beirut time in your team's dedicated Discord channel. It takes under two minutes and replaces status meetings. We read every one, and we only reply when you need something, so no reply means keep going.

Copy this format:

```
Team:
Status: Green / Amber / Red
Done today:
Next:
Blocked on:
```

Status	Meaning
Green	On track for the next checkpoint
Amber	At risk; you could use input
Red	You will miss the next checkpoint without help

The rules:

- **One post per team.** Rotate who writes it.

- **Be honest.** Amber or Red early is good news for us; it means we can help in time. A surprise on 13 November is the only bad status.
- **Blocked for more than 24 hours?** Tag an associate instructor in your standup instead of waiting.
- **Nothing done today?** Post anyway and say so. Two missed standups in a row and we will check in with you.

Your checklist this week

- [ ] Mon 26 Oct: read this doc together as a team
- [ ] Mon 26 Oct: post your first daily standup by 9:00 PM
- [ ] Mon 26 Oct: book your scope review call with Sami
- [ ] Tue 27 Oct: fill the scope template
- [ ] 3 hours before your call: send the filled template
- [ ] By Thu 29 Oct: scope locked on the call
- [ ] Every day after: standup by 9:00 PM

Questions about this doc? Ask in your team's Discord channel or leave a comment right here.